

Spirit of Racing

Version 1.0

A single-file motorsport career simulator. Race in the sim of your choice, enter the results here, and SoR turns them into a living championship — standings, qualifying grids, driver ratings, relationships, and an optional AI-driven narrative of emails and paddock drama.

One HTML file. No install, no account, no server.

Quick start

1. Download `SoR_v10_001.html` and open it in any modern browser
2. Pick a season on the splash screen and click **Enter Season**
3. On the **Career** tab, set your name and pick the driver slot you're taking over
4. On **Races**, open Round 1 and hit **Start ▶** to reveal the grid
5. Go race it in your sim, come back, enter the finishing positions, hit **Save Results**

That's the loop. Everything else builds on it.

Your save lives in the browser's localStorage, so it stays on your machine. **Export regularly** — clearing browser data wipes it.

What it does without an API key

The whole game works with the AI switched off:

- **Standings** — driver and constructor championships
- **Qualifying grids** — generated each round from form, championship position, car strength and driver rating
- **Driver ratings** — earned from grid-vs-finish across every season, or set by hand
- **Goals** — a target driver each round, calculated locally
- **Championship odds** — a real probability, computed deterministically
- **Relationships** — every driver's attitude toward you, shifting race by race
- **History** — a permanent record of every championship you've completed
- **Celebrations** — confetti and a synthesised brass fanfare on podiums and titles
- **Season types** — standard, street, multiclass, one-make, endurance

What the API key adds

An inbox. After each round you can pull a report from your crew:

- **Stefano**, crew chief — your drive, the result, the championship picture

- **Andrea**, personal assistant — the paddock: feuds, sightings, contract manoeuvring, whose personal life is leaking into their driving
- **Press** — coverage of the championship from outside
- **Race Direction** — penalties and notices

Plus transfer offers, rival team approaches, and a narrative arc that runs the length of the season.

Bring your own [Anthropic API key](#). You're billed directly by Anthropic; SoR takes nothing. Only the emails cost anything — every other system is local.

To spend less: switch individual cast members off in Settings, or check messages every few rounds rather than every round. Skipping doesn't lose anything — the next report becomes a chapter covering everything since you last read.

Season types

Set in the roster editor under Race Settings.

Type	What changes
Standard	A normal championship
Street Mode	Underground racing — no press, no stewards, no officials. A scene correspondent replaces the journalist
Multiclass	Two classes of five teams racing together, scored separately. Enter your overall position; SoR derives your class position
One-Make	Everyone in identical machinery. Enter the car name, hit Build grid , and every driver gets their own numbered entry — no teammates, no tiers
Endurance	Race length in minutes rather than laps

The qualifying model

Grids aren't random. Each round blends:

- **Last race form** — the dominant signal early in a season
- **Championship position** — weighted more heavily as the season progresses, so a title contender who had one bad Sunday still starts near the front for the finale
- **Car strength** — pulls quick cars forward, never pushes slow ones back
- **Driver rating** — sets how *predictable* a driver is, not just how fast

On top of that: pole is a weighted lottery among the front runners so nobody monopolises it; nobody starts in the same slot three races running; teammates never end up absurdly far apart; the back row is never a single-team lockout; and occasionally a backmarker has a lucky session.

Grid penalties show as a red **-N grid penalty** beside the affected driver, with the reason on hover.

Driver ratings

Ratings run **F** through **A**, with **A+** for drivers who've finished top three in a completed championship. They're earned from what a driver does relative to their car, across every season you've played.

You can also set them by hand. The roster editor has a dropdown next to every driver — leave it on **Auto**, or pick a grade to match a real driver's reputation. A manual grade applies immediately, overrides the calculated one, follows that driver across seasons, and shows in gold.

Rating drives *consistency* as well as pace: an A+ driver lands close to their expected grid slot every time, while a D-rated one is scattered.

Tips

- **Use a wide tier spread.** Try 1, 2, 3, 5, 7, 8, 9, 10 rather than clustering everyone in 1-3. Real grids have real midfield gaps.
 - **Set ratings for real drivers.** A roster of real names lands much better when the grades match reputations.
 - **Tier numbers never leak into the fiction.** Characters describe cars in words, so you can retune mid-season for competitive balance without it showing up in an email.
 - **Let relationships develop.** They move on their own. Nudge them manually only to make peace or escalate a grudge.
 - **Export before big changes** — resetting, switching seasons, editing the roster.
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Saving

- **↓ Export** — dated JSON backup of everything
- **↑ Import** — restore from a backup, replacing current data

localStorage is per-browser and per-device. Export after every session and keep a couple of recent backups.

Credits

Spirit of Racing — Arm Chair Development AI narrative powered by Claude (Anthropic)

Inspired by all the great racing, and racing games, of the past and present.

An independent production. Not affiliated with any racing series, manufacturer, or sanctioning body.

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